

Notes: Kumar, Lee, Lowe & Ogunnote (AER, 2026)

Internal versus Institutional Barriers to Gender Equality: Evidence from British Politics

Contents

1	Big picture	2
2	Data and measurement	2
2.1	PMQs lotteries and entrants	2
2.2	Electoral outcomes	2
2.3	Gender, cohort, party, and MP characteristics	3
2.4	Hybrid-period measures	3
2.5	Question, response, rowdiness, and voice-volume data	3
3	Models and empirical specifications	4
3.1	Lottery-based effects of asking a question	4
3.2	Gender gap in question submission	4
3.3	Hybrid-period difference-in-differences interpretation	4
3.4	Peer-experience specification	4
3.5	Question and response characteristics	4
3.6	Rowdiness and speaking-volume mechanisms	5
4	Identification and empirical design	5
4.1	Why the PMQs lottery is powerful	5
4.2	Why the hybrid change is informative	5
4.3	Mechanism evidence	5
4.4	What the paper cannot fully prove	6
5	Tables and figures	6
5.1	Table 1 + Table 2: PMQs is valuable, but women enter less often	6
5.2	Figure 1 + Figure 2: the gap is persistent; experience does not raise future entry	7
5.3	Figure 3: experience does not affect women and men differently	7
5.4	Figure 4 + Figure 5: the gender gap closes when PMQs goes hybrid	8
5.5	Table 3 + Figure 6: composition checks and voting placebo	9
5.6	Figure 7 + Figure 8: event timing and question/response characteristics	9
5.7	Table 4 + Table 5: rowdiness and voice-volume mechanisms	10
6	Short summary	11
7	Conclusion	11
7.1	Core conclusion	11
7.2	Economic intuition	11
7.3	Takeaway	12

1 Big picture

- **Question.** Can gender gaps in a male-dominated, adversarial workplace be reduced by women gaining experience in that setting, or by changing the institution itself?
- **Setting.** The paper studies Prime Minister’s Questions (PMQs) in the UK Parliament. MPs can enter weekly lotteries to ask the prime minister a question in a public, televised, noisy, and adversarial chamber.
- **Why PMQs matters.** PMQs is politically valuable. Lottery winners who ask questions receive a higher subsequent vote margin, so the task has career benefits rather than being merely symbolic.
- **Core gender gap.** Before the pandemic-induced format change, women were less likely than same-cohort men to submit PMQs questions. The preferred estimate is about a 5.9 percentage point gap, or roughly 12 percent relative to male entry.
- **Internal-barrier hypothesis.** If women adapt to the male-dominated environment through experience, then lottery-induced experience asking PMQs questions should close the gender gap.
- **Institutional-barrier hypothesis.** If the setting itself deters women, then changing the format of PMQs should close the gap even without women needing to adapt.
- **Main experience result.** Lottery-induced experience does not increase future question entry and does not close the gender gap. Women and men respond similarly after winning.
- **Main institutional result.** When PMQs switched to hybrid proceedings during COVID-19—with a much smaller in-person audience and remote participation—the gender gap almost completely closed.
- **Mechanism.** The evidence points more to noise, rowdiness, and adversarial atmosphere than to remote flexibility alone. Rowdy exchanges discourage women more than men, and louder women enter more often before hybrid proceedings.
- **Economic takeaway.** In adversarial, male-dominated environments, experience-based policies may be ineffective when the institution remains mismatched to women’s preferences or constraints. Institutional change can have large effects.

2 Data and measurement

2.1 PMQs lotteries and entrants

- PMQs allows backbench MPs to question the prime minister in front of Parliament.
- MPs submit questions to a weekly lottery; selected winners normally ask their question at the next PMQs.
- The authors obtain data from the House of Commons Table Office on weekly PMQs lottery entrants and winners from 2015 to 2023.
- The main entry outcome is

$$Submitted_{it} = 1$$

if MP i entered the PMQs lottery on date t .

- For earlier and later periods where entrant data are unavailable, the authors use lottery winners as a proxy for entry.

Interpretation: The lottery provides random variation in whether an entrant actually gets the experience of asking a PMQs question. The entrant data provide the intensive-margin participation outcome.

2.2 Electoral outcomes

- The paper links lottery entries and wins to subsequent general-election outcomes.

- Outcomes include whether the MP ran again, vote share at the next general election, vote margin at the next general election, and whether the MP won.
- The main electoral interpretation is relative to the lottery-loser mean: a 0.528 percentage point increase in vote margin is roughly a 4 percent increase relative to the 14 percentage point loser mean.

Interpretation: Establishing that PMQs matters electorally is important because it shows that the gender gap concerns a valuable career-enhancing activity.

2.3 Gender, cohort, party, and MP characteristics

- Gender is coded as a binary variable because no politicians in the analysis period are nonbinary.
- Cohort fixed effects compare MPs who entered Parliament during the same parliamentary term.
- Party fixed effects compare women and men within party.
- Additional controls include electoral margin, political posts, parliamentary posts, education, ethnicity, and background characteristics.

Interpretation: Cohort controls are central because female representation has increased over time. Without cohort controls, women would tend to have less parliamentary experience than men, confounding gender with seniority.

2.4 Hybrid-period measures

- The hybrid PMQs period began in April 2020 and allowed remote questioning.
- In-person attendance in the chamber was capped and fell sharply.
- The post-hybrid period begins when proceedings returned to an in-person-only format.
- The main period indicators are $PreHybrid_t$, $Hybrid_t$, and $PostHybrid_t$.

Interpretation: The format change supplies a natural test of whether institutional design, rather than experience, explains the gender gap.

2.5 Question, response, rowdiness, and voice-volume data

- Hansard transcripts and manually coded PMQs exchanges are used to measure question and response features.
- Coded question features include whether the question is about a constituency issue, humor, a request, an issue update, agreement, self-promotion, or a condemnatory statement.
- Response features include whether the prime minister answered, agreed, used humor, or whether the MP or PM was interrupted.
- Rowdy exchange equals one when the question-answer exchange includes a rowdy interruption.
- YouTube videos are used to extract speaking volume for MPs asking questions.

Interpretation: These variables let the paper move beyond documenting a gender gap and ask which features of adversarial speech may deter women.

3 Models and empirical specifications

3.1 Lottery-based effects of asking a question

The stacked lottery specification is

$$y_{i,t+k} = \alpha_t + \beta_k Won_{it} + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (1)$$

- Won_{it} equals one if MP i won lottery t .
- α_t are lottery-date fixed effects.
- For electoral outcomes, $y_{i,t+k}$ is performance in the next general election.
- For experience outcomes, $y_{i,t+k} = Entered_{i,t+k}$ for future lotteries $k = 1, \dots, 5$.

Interpretation: Because winners and losers are compared within the same lottery, β_k is an intent-to-treat effect of being selected to ask a question.

3.2 Gender gap in question submission

The main gender-gap specification is

$$Submitted_{it} = \alpha_t + \alpha_c + \beta Female_i + \gamma' X_{it} + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (2)$$

- α_t are lottery-date fixed effects.
- α_c are parliamentary-cohort fixed effects.
- $Female_i$ equals one for female MPs.
- X_{it} includes party fixed effects and other controls in richer specifications.

Interpretation: The coefficient β is the gender gap in entry among MPs eligible to enter on the same date and, depending on the specification, with the same cohort and party.

3.3 Hybrid-period difference-in-differences interpretation

A compact way to write the hybrid-period test is

$$Submitted_{it} = \alpha_t + \alpha_c + \theta_1 Female_i + \theta_2 (Female_i \times Hybrid_t) + \theta_3 (Female_i \times PostHybrid_t) + \Gamma' X_{it} + u_{it}. \quad (3)$$

Interpretation: A positive θ_2 means the female-minus-male gap narrows during hybrid PMQs. A positive θ_3 means the narrowing persists after the return to in-person-only PMQs.

3.4 Peer-experience specification

To test whether women learn from other women asking questions, the paper estimates

$$Entered_{i,t+k} = \alpha_{s(t)} + \beta_{k1} FemaleWinners_{-i,t} + \beta_{k2} Won_{it} \quad (1)$$

$$+ \gamma_{k1} FemaleEntrants_{-i,t} + \gamma_{k2} MaleEntrants_{-i,t} + \gamma_{k3} Entered_{it} + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (4)$$

Interpretation: The key regressor is the randomly assigned number of other female winners. This isolates peer exposure from the endogenous number of women who entered.

3.5 Question and response characteristics

For coded question-answer exchanges, the paper estimates

$$Characteristic_{itr} = \alpha_t + \alpha_c + \alpha_p + \alpha_r + \beta Female_i + \varepsilon_{itr}. \quad (5)$$

- α_t are week fixed effects.
- α_c are cohort fixed effects.
- α_p are party fixed effects.
- α_r are coder fixed effects.

Interpretation: This asks whether female MPs ask different questions, receive different answers, or experience different interruptions, conditional on the same week, cohort, party, and coding process.

3.6 Rowdiness and speaking-volume mechanisms

The rowdy-exchange test can be written conceptually as

$$EnteredNext_{it} = \alpha + \beta_F(Female_i \times Rowdy_{it}) + \beta_M(Male_i \times Rowdy_{it}) + Controls + FE + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (6)$$

The speaking-volume test is

$$Entered_{it} = \alpha_t + \alpha_c + \alpha_p + \delta Female_i + \lambda_F(Volume_i \times Female_i) + \lambda_M(Volume_i \times Male_i) + \varepsilon_{it}. \quad (7)$$

Interpretation: If noise and heckling deter women, then rowdy exchanges should reduce women’s future entry and louder women should be more willing to enter before the format change.

4 Identification and empirical design

4.1 Why the PMQs lottery is powerful

- The lottery randomly determines which entrants receive the experience of asking a question.
- Lottery fixed effects compare winners and losers from the same week.
- Balance tests on predetermined variables support the randomization.
- Because 97 percent of pre-hybrid winners ultimately ask their question, winning is a strong proxy for actual question-asking experience.

Interpretation: The lottery lets the paper distinguish the effect of experience from selection into entry.

4.2 Why the hybrid change is informative

- Hybrid PMQs reduced the size and intensity of the physical audience and allowed remote participation.
- The gender gap narrows precisely at the format change.
- The gender gap in voting attendance does not change in the same way, providing a placebo outcome.
- Event-study comparisons around other political-calendar events do not show the same pattern.

Interpretation: The hybrid evidence supports the institutional-barrier view: changing the setting itself changes female participation.

4.3 Mechanism evidence

- Women use humor less often pre-hybrid, and the prime minister uses less humor in responses to women.
- Rowdy exchanges deter female MPs from entering again, while they appear to motivate male MPs.
- Women ask questions more quietly than men pre-hybrid.
- Louder women enter more often pre-hybrid, but this relation disappears after hybrid proceedings.

Interpretation: The mechanism results point to the adversarial and noisy nature of PMQs rather than only the convenience of remote access.

4.4 What the paper cannot fully prove

- The hybrid reform bundled several changes: smaller audience, remote option, pandemic timing, and changes in political salience.
- Rowdiness is not randomly assigned, so Table 4 is mechanism evidence rather than a clean experiment.
- The 2023–2025 persistence analysis uses lottery winners rather than entrants because entrant data are unavailable.
- Gender is treated as binary because of the institutional data and sample period.

Interpretation: The paper’s strongest evidence is the combination of random lottery experience, null experience effects, a large hybrid-period shift, placebo checks, and mechanism tests pointing in the same direction.

5 Tables and figures

The figures and tables below are directly cropped from the original paper and grouped compactly to improve reading speed.

5.1 Table 1 + Table 2: PMQs is valuable, but women enter less often

Read:

- Table 1 shows that winning the PMQs lottery raises the next-election vote margin by 0.528 percentage points for all entrants.
- Relative to the 14 percentage point loser mean, this is about a 4 percent improvement in vote margin.
- The vote-margin effect is larger for female entrants in point estimates, though the gender difference is not statistically significant.
- Table 2 shows the pre-hybrid gender gap in entry. With cohort and party fixed effects, women enter 5.86 percentage points less often than men.
- The gap is concentrated on the intensive margin: women are not much less likely to ever enter, but conditional entrants submit less often.

Economic message: PMQs participation has career value, so lower female entry reflects a meaningful gender gap in access to a visible political opportunity.

TABLE 1—LOTTERY WINNERS RECEIVE HIGHER VOTE MARGINS IN THE NEXT ELECTION

	Ran for next GE (1)	Vote share at next GE (%) (2)	Vote margin at next GE (%) (3)	Won next GE (4)
<i>Panel A. All entrants</i>				
Won PMQs lottery	−0.001 (0.005)	0.326 (0.166)	0.528 (0.284)	0.009 (0.007)
<i>Panel B. Female entrants</i>				
Won PMQs lottery	0.003 (0.008)	0.391 (0.261)	0.807 (0.475)	0.018 (0.012)
<i>Panel C. Male entrants</i>				
Won PMQs lottery	−0.004 (0.007)	0.229 (0.207)	0.255 (0.349)	0.002 (0.009)
All entrants observations	75,299	66,274	66,274	66,274
Number of MPs	835	771	771	771
Lottery losers outcome mean	0.88	45.8	14	0.719
Previous vote margin	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Previous vote share	No	Yes	No	No
<i>p(female effect = male effect)</i>	0.47	0.63	0.35	0.26

Notes: The data includes the full set of lottery entrants for the 264 lotteries from 2015 to 2023, excluding two lotteries for which the associated PMQs were cancelled. Outcome variables are (column 1) dummy variable for whether the

TABLE 2—WOMEN ARE LESS LIKELY TO SUBMIT QUESTIONS TO THE PRIME MINISTER

	Entered				Entry percentage (5)	Ever entered (6)	Entry percentage (7)
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)			
Female	−7.12 (2.19)	−5.86 (2.23)	−5.22 (2.18)	−5.42 (2.18)	−5.31 (2.11)	−1.13 (2.37)	−5.94 (1.76)
Observations	87,137	87,137	87,137	87,137	2,373	2,373	1,927
Number of MPs	890	890	890	890	890	890	791
Sample	All	All	All	All	All	All	Entered ≥ 1
Male outcome mean	49.4	49.4	49.4	49.4	48	79	61
Lottery fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Cohort fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Party fixed effects	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Margin and posts	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Additional controls	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
Session fixed effects	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: The unit of observation is MP-lottery for the stacked specification in columns 1 to 4, with 157 lotteries from 2015 to 2020 (the pre-hybrid era). The unit of observation is MP-session in columns 5 to 7. We exclude the short 2019 session for which 340 questions were submitted, below which the total number of questions was 798, compared to the previous 1,927.

(a) Lottery winners receive higher vote margins.

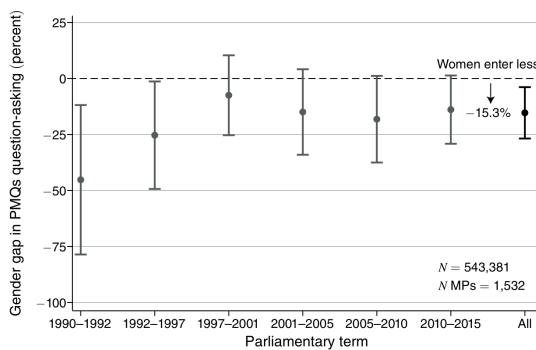
(b) Women are less likely to submit PMQs questions.

5.2 Figure 1 + Figure 2: the gap is persistent; experience does not raise future entry

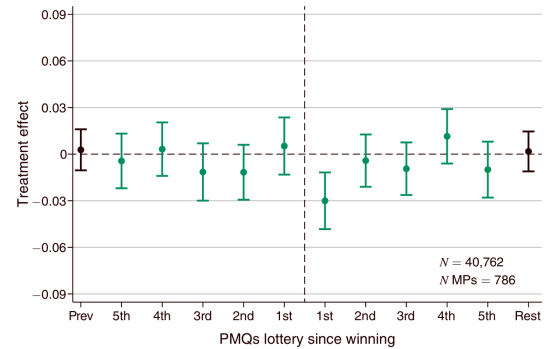
Read:

- Figure 1 shows that the gender gap in PMQs question-asking has existed since at least 1990.
- The pooled historical estimate is about a 15.3 percent gap.
- Figure 2 shows that winning a lottery does not increase later entry.
- Winners are slightly less likely to enter the next PMQs, then return to behavior similar to losers.
- The result does not support the idea that experience makes MPs more willing to ask questions.

Economic message: A long-running gender gap remains even in an elite political setting, and task-specific experience does not solve it.



(a) Gender differences persisted since 1990.



(b) Experience does not increase future entry.

5.3 Figure 3: experience does not affect women and men differently

Read:

- Female lottery winners and male lottery winners show similar dynamic effects after winning.
- Both groups have a small negative effect in the next lottery and null effects afterward.
- There is no evidence that women uniquely benefit from experience.

Economic message: Experience-based policies would need women to respond differently to experience. The data do not show that.

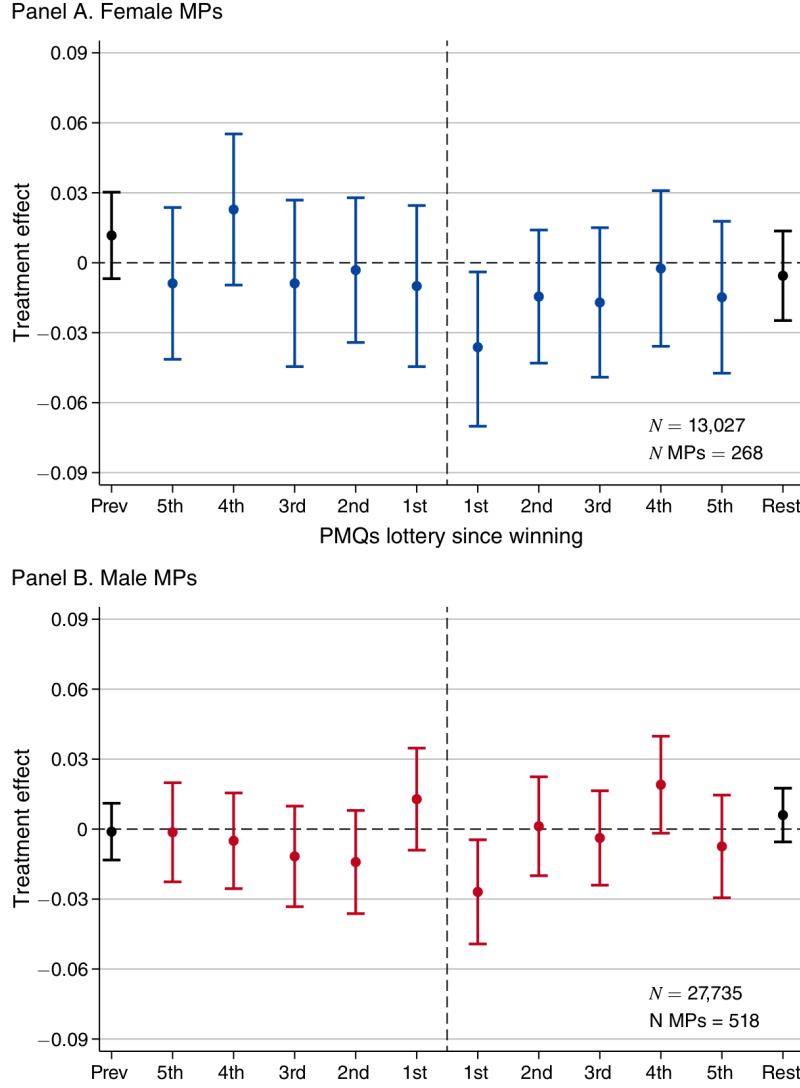


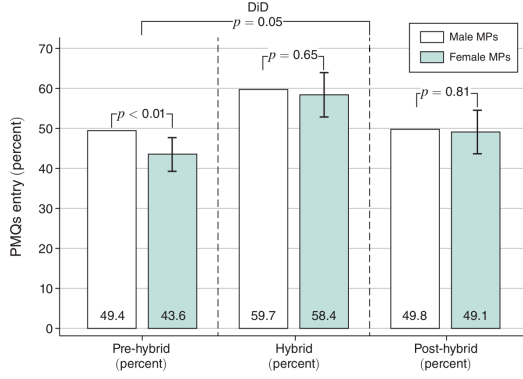
Figure 3: Experience does not affect the gender gap in question-asking.

5.4 Figure 4 + Figure 5: the gender gap closes when PMQs goes hybrid

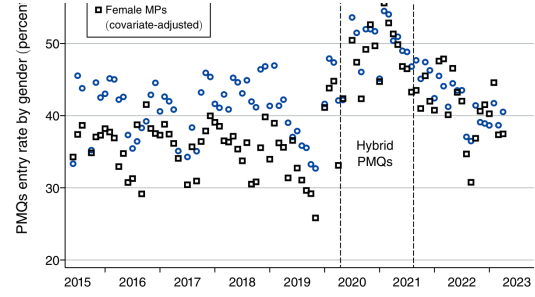
Read:

- Figure 4 shows raw/covariate-adjusted entry rates by gender across pre-hybrid, hybrid, and post-hybrid periods.
- Pre-hybrid, male MPs enter 49.4 percent of the time and female MPs enter 43.6 percent.
- Hybrid, the rates become 59.7 percent and 58.4 percent; the preferred gap narrows by about 77 percent.
- Post-hybrid, the gap remains very small: 49.8 percent for men versus 49.1 percent for women.
- Figure 5 shows the same pattern monthly: female entry rises during hybrid proceedings and tracks male entry more closely afterward.

Economic message: A change in institutional format does what experience does not: it almost completely closes the participation gap.



(a) Hybrid proceedings nearly close the gap.



(b) Monthly entry by gender.

5.5 Table 3 + Figure 6: composition checks and voting placebo

Read:

- Table 3 shows positive Female $\times$ Hybrid and Female $\times$ Post-Hybrid coefficients, meaning the female gap narrows after the reform.
- The result survives MP fixed effects, which removes time-invariant MP composition.
- The p-values in the bottom row reject equality between the pre-hybrid gap and the hybrid-onward gap.
- Figure 6 shows the voting-attendance placebo: women have somewhat lower voting attendance, but the gap does not change when PMQs goes hybrid.

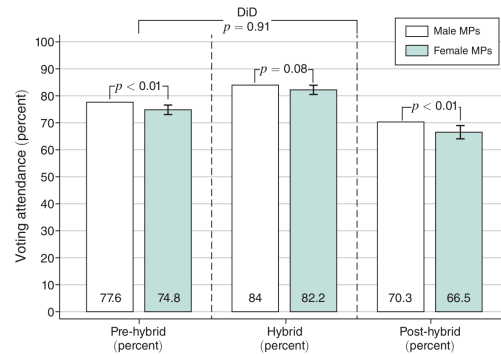
Economic message: The narrowing is not simply due to composition, calendar effects, or a general increase in women's political participation during the pandemic.

TABLE 3—THE CLOSING OF THE GENDER GAP IS NOT DUE TO COMPOSITIONAL OR CALENDAR EFFECTS

	Entered		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
<i>Female</i>	-5.86 (2.23)		
<i>Female $\times$ hybrid</i>	4.53 (2.67)	4.81 (2.75)	5.55 (2.87)
<i>Female $\times$ post-hybrid</i>	5.18 (2.77)	5.46 (2.85)	5.66 (2.92)
Observations	146,205	146,199	138,671
Male outcome mean	51.4	51.4	51.6
Lottery FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cohort-period FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Party-period FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
MP FE	No	Yes	Yes
MP-calendar week FE	No	No	Yes
$p(\text{pre-hybrid gap} = \text{hybrid and after gap})$	0.05	0.05	0.04

Notes: The unit of observation is MP-lottery, including 264 lotteries from 2015 to 2023. The sample includes only those MPs eligible to enter each lottery (those without a government position). Entered is a variable equal to 100 if the MP entered the PMQs lottery and zero otherwise. Coefficients are then interpreted as percentage point effects. Cohort-period FE are cohort fixed effects.

(a) Closing of the gap is not composition/calendar.



(b) Voting-attendance gap is not affected.

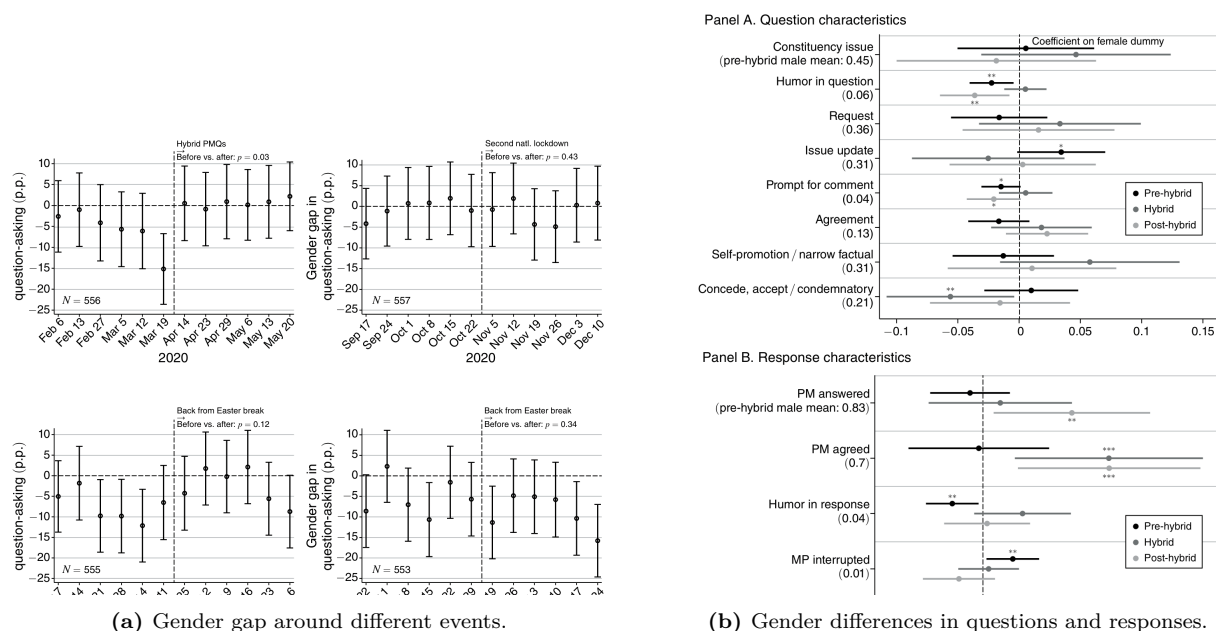
5.6 Figure 7 + Figure 8: event timing and question/response characteristics

Read:

- Figure 7 compares the gender gap around the hybrid switch, the second national lockdown, and Easter breaks.
- The gap narrows around the hybrid PMQs change, but not around the placebo events.

- Figure 8 shows gender differences in question and response characteristics across pre-hybrid, hybrid, and post-hybrid periods.
- Women use humor less often in pre-hybrid questions, and the prime minister uses less humor in responses to women.
- Some interruption-related gaps disappear after the hybrid change.

Economic message: The timing reinforces the institutional-change story, while the question/response patterns show why the pre-hybrid environment may have been especially mismatched for women.



5.7 Table 4 + Table 5: rowdiness and voice-volume mechanisms

Read:

- Table 4 shows that rowdy exchanges deter female MPs from entering the next week and appear to encourage male MPs.
- In column 3, Female $\times$ Rowdy Exchange is -10.55 percentage points, while Male $\times$ Rowdy Exchange is $+7.16$ percentage points.
- The p-value for equality between the female and male rowdiness effects is 0.02.
- Table 5 shows that female MPs ask questions about 0.79 dB more quietly than male MPs pre-hybrid.
- Speaking volume predicts pre-hybrid entry for women, but not during hybrid or post-hybrid proceedings.

Economic message: The mechanism evidence supports the noise/adversarial-setting interpretation. Hybrid proceedings did not merely add convenience; they reduced a specific institutional feature that appears to deter women.

TABLE 4—ROWDY EXCHANGES DETER FEMALE QUESTIONERS FROM FUTURE ENTRY MORE THAN MEN

	Entered next week		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
<i>Female</i> $\times$ rowdy exchange	−5.96 (5.55)	−7.42 (5.71)	−10.55 (5.89)
<i>Male</i> $\times$ rowdy exchange	4.80 (4.15)	7.03 (3.93)	7.16 (4.19)
Observations	2,159	2,085	2,085
Male outcome mean	75.3	75.5	75.5
Female dummy	Yes	Yes	Yes
PMQs week FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Past entry	No	Yes	Yes
Cohort-by-rowdy exchange FE	No	No	Yes
Party-by-rowdy exchange FE	No	No	Yes
$p(\text{female} \times \text{rowdy} = \text{male} \times \text{rowdy})$	0.12	0.04	0.02

Notes: The unit of observation is the PMQs exchange. The sample includes all MPs who won the lottery during the pre-hybrid era, asked their question, and remained eligible to enter the lottery in the following (pre-hybrid) week. We require Hansard transcripts to measure rowdiness, which limits us to 150 of the 157 pre-hybrid PMQs. *Rowdy exchange* is an indicator variable equal to one if an interruption occurred during the exchange between the

(a) Rowdy exchanges deter female questioners.

TABLE 5—LOUDER WOMEN SUBMIT QUESTIONS MORE OFTEN PRE-HYBRID, BUT NOT AFTER HYBRID

	Volume	Entered			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
<i>Female</i>	−0.79 (0.12)	−5.59 (2.13)	39.29 (28.76)	0.45 (44.09)	26.77 (46.79)
<i>Speaking volume</i> $\times$ <i>female</i>			1.88 (0.76)	−0.01 (1.20)	−0.01 (1.29)
<i>Speaking volume</i> $\times$ <i>male</i>			0.29 (0.71)	−0.07 (1.01)	−0.93 (1.07)
Observations	2,141	66,031	66,031	17,861	19,655
Sample	Pre-hybrid	Pre-hybrid	Pre-hybrid	Hybrid	Post-hybrid
Male outcome mean	−27.2	62.7	62.7	65.7	55.0
$p(\text{vol} \times \text{fem} = \text{vol} \times \text{male})$			0.13	0.97	0.58
Date FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cohort FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Party FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: The unit of observation is MP-date. The sample for column 1 includes the lottery winner questions asked at pre-hybrid PMOs with available YouTube videos. The sample for the remainine columns includes the MPs eligible

(b) Louder women submit more often pre-hybrid.

6 Short summary

- The paper studies gender gaps in PMQs question submission in the UK Parliament.
- PMQs questions are high stakes: lottery winners have higher next-election vote margins.
- Before hybrid proceedings, women enter PMQs lotteries less often than same-cohort men.
- The preferred pre-hybrid gender gap is 5.86 percentage points, about 12 percent relative to male entry.
- The gender gap is on the intensive margin: women are not much less likely to ever enter, but enter less often conditional on entering.
- Lottery-induced experience asking a question does not increase future entry.
- The null experience effect is similar for women and men, so experience does not close the gender gap.
- The hybrid PMQs format nearly eliminates the gap, narrowing it by roughly 77 percent.
- Placebo and event-study checks support the interpretation that the format change mattered.
- Rowdiness deters women more than men, and louder women enter more often pre-hybrid.
- The results support institutional change rather than simply asking women to adapt to a male-dominated setting.

7 Conclusion

7.1 Core conclusion

Kumar, Lee, Lowe, and Ogunnote show that a persistent gender gap in a valuable political task does not close through task-specific experience. Instead, the gap almost completely closes when the workplace format changes. The central contrast is clear: women do not adapt to the institution after randomly assigned experience, but participation changes when the institution adapts.

7.2 Economic intuition

The PMQs environment combines high visibility, high stakes, noise, heckling, and a male-dominated chamber. These features can create a mismatch between the workplace and the preferences or constraints of women. Experience alone does not remove that mismatch. Reducing the adversarial intensity of the environment changes the cost-benefit calculation and draws more women into participation.

7.3 Takeaway

The paper's broader lesson is that gender gaps in elite, competitive workplaces need not disappear through exposure or experience. When the workplace itself is designed around male-dominated norms, institutional reforms may be more effective than policies that ask women to adjust to those norms.